

Tobias Treppmann

Head of UX — builds the design function, and decides where AI belongs in how it works

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PROFILE

I build design functions and give them standing. At Ninox that meant a team across product design and UX writing, a seat on the Senior Leadership Team, and a levelling framework I wrote myself. The last year went into the AI half of the job in production, with the guardrails built into the design, not written into a memo.

Nine reports

across four disciplines at Ninox, leading design and product at once

Live in production

an AI support copilot with every send decision human, and an LLM-safe design system

10 years

mentoring and coaching designers at CareerFoundry

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (B2C streaming product — iOS, Android, web, connected TV; product managers and product owners in-house, engineering at external agencies) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- An AI support copilot, live in production, with the guardrails in the design. It drafts in the handbook's wording, carries an explicit restricted-topic list, and leaves every send decision human.
- Rolled out optional; skeptics converted after their hardest case.
- A design system built to hold under AI-assisted work. Storybook as the source of truth; checks reject a token that does not exist or a value written straight into a component.
- Product managers prototype against real components; the standard holds.
- Introduced agentic engineering as a design practice. I prototype in real code against production APIs, and the external engineering agency ships from that code.
- An AI fundraising system, built end to end: analysis of past letters, a Claude Project that asks clarifying questions before it writes, a production Claude skill across three surfaces.
- I set the standard product managers build to and hold final design sign-off. Product manager and product owner for the redesign as well.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- 70% less coordination time, 90% booking acceptance. I embedded the funeral-booking brief in the platform's calendar and form builder, so one build carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings for every customer.
- Product management for the main platform, and all of product design. Wrote the specs, ran the ticket board, main contact for the launch customer.
- Customers met a legal accessibility deadline automatically, across six countries.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Senior Leadership Team; five direct reports across product design and UX writing, including a design lead. Responsible for capacity, allocation, prioritization of work, team structure and processes.
- Wrote the team's levelling framework for design and UX writing. Both promotions, a designer to Design Lead and a senior designer to Principal, were made against it.
- Ran performance reviews and a lean 360.
- Interim Head of Product, July to October 2023: three product managers and a data scientist, nine reports across four disciplines in all. Brought in the consultant who became Head of Product.
- Owned the design system and established joint governance with engineering. My component work ships in the app in the stores, including the redesign.
- Coached the design lead through a strained engineering relationship and redesigned how the team met: agendas in advance, material shared early, turn-taking, decisions in writing.
- Research at a scale a team cannot read by hand: Claude over thousands of forum posts; Dovetail as the shared repository.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Design-thinking training for the executive leadership and the service teams, and recurring workshops with department heads moving case-by-case support toward a productized catalog.
- Held the Facilitator and Secretary roles in a Holacracy organization, including governance meetings.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Took design from an execution function to a strategic partner, with executive support secured for user research.
- Reached analysts inside regulated banks through iterative screening on usertesting.com, and research protocols that fed product development.
- Led the design team across Germany and NYC, two UX designers reporting to me.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · user interviews that reversed an executive assumption; stakeholder dynamics in a matrix organization

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, Pennsylvania, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, Pennsylvania, USA

Web Designer / Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, Pennsylvania, USA

Earlier · *Web Designer, Bajaa.com and freelance* · 2000 – 2009 · remote

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Leading design and research

levelling framework, growth plans and performance reviews · hiring and promotion · coaching through one-to-ones · a lean 360 run as a workshop · capacity, allocation and prioritization · design-system governance with engineering · usertesting.com, Dovetail, interview analysis with Claude · a decade mentoring and coaching designers at CareerFoundry

AI in the design and research workflow

Claude Code as the daily method · Claude Projects and skills · prompt architecture and context design · human-in-the-loop by design · restricted-topic lists and scope rules · agentic engineering · LLM-safe token vocabularies · taught AI for design and prototyping to another company's team leads

Design systems

DTCG design tokens · Style Dictionary · Storybook · Figma and Figma Variables · OKLCH color and WCAG contrast · custom motion easing curves in the system · design systems built in three organizations

Leadership methods

Design Thinking training for executives · Co-Creation workshops · Holacracy Facilitator and Secretary · navigating difficult stakeholder dynamics in a matrix organization · prioritizing work against competing priorities and team capacity · presenting to C-level and executive teams